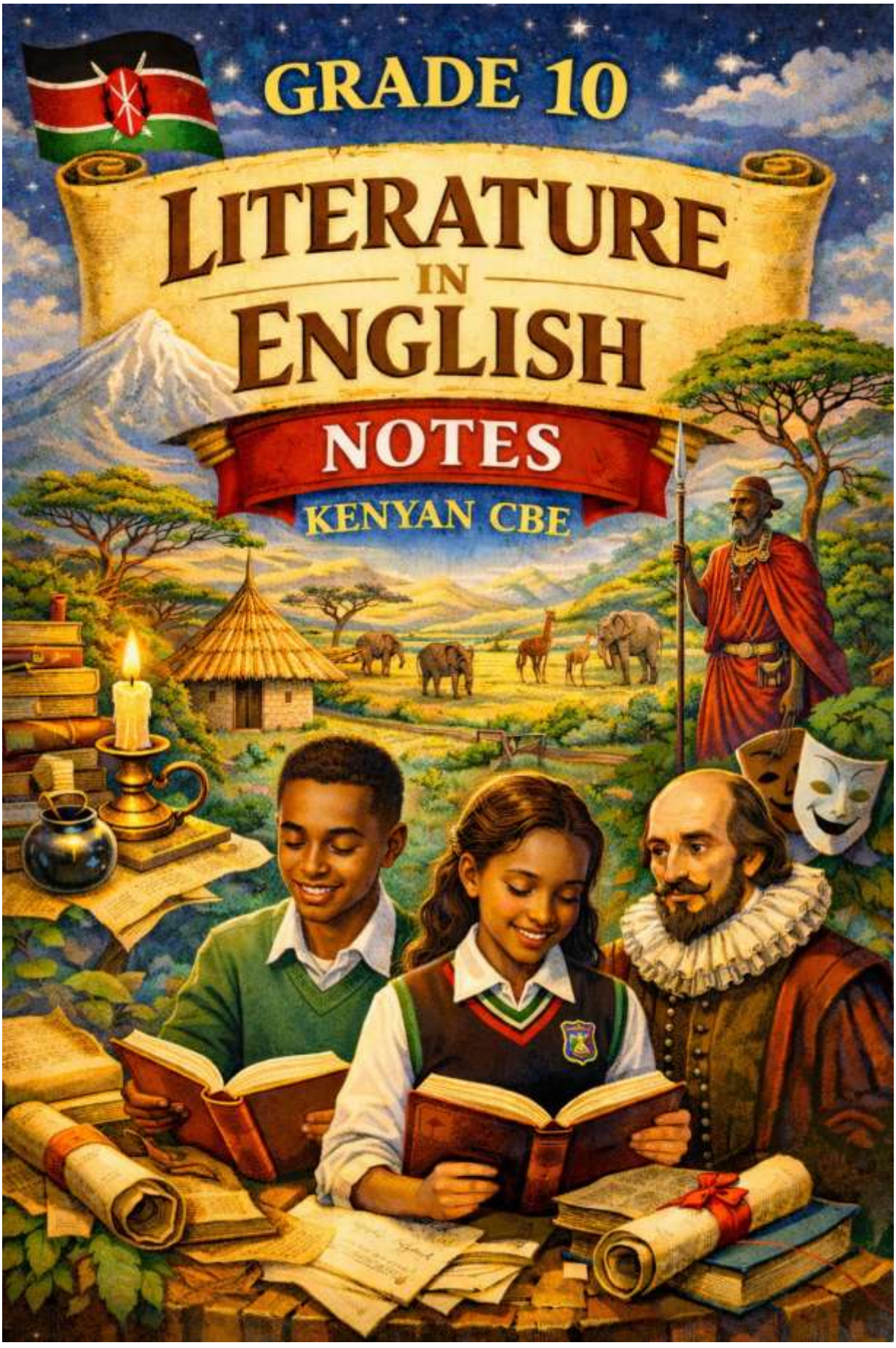

GRADE 10
LITERATURE
IN
ENGLISH
NOTES
KENYAN CBE

GRADE 10 LITERATURE IN ENGLISH

NOTES

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STRAND 1.0 ORAL LITERATURE

These notes are designed for Grade 10 learners to master the concept of Oral Literature. They are structured to cover definitions, features, genres, and the practical application of fieldwork. Oral Literature is not just stories from the past; it is a living, breathing art form that shapes our identity and society today.

SUB-STRAND 1.1: INTRODUCTION TO ORAL LITERATURE

1. Definition and Concept

- **What is Oral Literature?**
    - Oral literature refers to those utterances, whether spoken, recited, or sung, whose composition and performance exhibit to an appreciable degree the artistic characteristics of accurate observation, vivid imagination, and ingenious expression.
    - It is often referred to as **"Orature"** (a term coined by Pio Zirimu) to distinguish it from written literature.
    - Unlike written literature, which relies on scripts and books, oral literature relies on the **spoken word** and **memory** for its preservation and transmission from one generation to another.

- It is a performance-based art; it only truly exists when it is being performed by an artist (narrator/singer) to an audience.

2. The Three Major Genres of Oral Literature To study oral literature systematically, we classify it into three main categories (genres).

- **Oral Narratives (Prose):**
  - These are stories told in ordinary, non-rhythmic language.
  - They include myths, legends, folktales, trickster stories, and ogre stories.
  - They usually have a plot, characters, setting, and a resolution.
- **Oral Poetry (Songs):**
  - These are expressions of feelings, ideas, or thoughts in rhythmic language. ○ The distinction between a poem and a song in oral literature is often thin, as most poems are chanted or sung. ○ Examples include lullabies, initiation songs, wedding songs, work songs, and dirges (funeral songs).
- **Short Forms (Fixed Forms):**
  - These are brief, compact utterances that are often rigid in structure (the wording rarely changes).
  - They are "short" in length but deep in meaning. ○ Examples include proverbs, riddles, tongue twisters, and puns.

3. Distinctive Features of Oral Literature What makes oral literature different from written books?

- **Orality:** It is delivered by word of mouth. The sound of the words is as important as the meaning.
- **Performance:** It depends on an artist (performer) and an audience. A story in a book is static; a story told orally comes alive through acting.
- **Audience Participation:** The audience in oral literature is active, not passive. They clap, sing the chorus, answer riddles, or even correct the narrator.
- **Dynamism (Adaptability):** Oral texts are not fixed. A narrator can change the character names or the setting of a story to fit the current audience or location. The story adapts to the times.
- **Memory:** It relies on human memory for storage. This is why many oral forms use repetition—to help the narrator and audience remember.
- **Integration:** It is often integrated with other arts like dance, music, drama, and costume.

4. Functions of Oral Literature in Society Why do communities engage in storytelling and singing?

- **Education (Pedagogy):** Before schools existed, oral literature was the classroom. Narratives taught history; proverbs taught wisdom and ethics; riddles sharpened the mind.
- **Socialization:** It teaches young people the values, norms, and expectations of their society (e.g., respecting elders, being brave).
- **Entertainment:** It provides amusement and relaxation after a day's work.
- **Social Control:** Satirical songs or stories mock laziness, greed, or theft, shaming offenders into correcting their behavior.
- **History and Identity:** Myths and legends explain where the community came from

(origin) and who their heroes are, fostering a sense of belonging.

Tip for Learners: When asked to give the "function" of a specific item (like a proverb), do not just say "it teaches." Be specific. Say, "It teaches the value of patience," or "It warns against greed."

ACTIVITY FOR SUB-STRAND 1.1

1. **Brainstorm:** In small groups, list five stories or proverbs you were told as a child.
2. **Categorize:** Group them into the three genres: Narrative, Song, or Short Form.
3. **Discuss:** Why were those specific stories told to you? Was it to make you sleep? To stop you from doing something bad? To make you laugh?

SUB-STRAND 2.1 & 5.1: ORAL NARRATIVES (With Focus on Trickster Narratives)

1. Features of Oral Narratives Oral narratives are more than just plots; they have specific structural elements.

- **Opening Formula:**
    - Phrases used to begin a story (e.g., "Once upon a time," "A long time ago"). ○ **Function:** It grabs the audience's attention and transports them from the real world to the world of fantasy.
- **Closing Formula:**
    - Phrases used to end a story (e.g., "And that is why...", "That is the end of my story").
    - **Function:** It signals the end of the performance and releases the audience back to reality.
- **Use of Dialogue:** Characters speak to one another, making the story dramatic and realistic.
- **Repetition:** Actions or songs are often repeated to create rhythm, emphasize a point, or build suspense.
- **Fantasy/Hyperbole:** Animals talk, humans fly, and magic happens. Exaggeration is used for effect.
- **Moral Lesson:** Most narratives end with a teaching point.

2. The Trickster Narrative (Detailed Focus) Grade 10 focuses heavily on Trickster Narratives. These are the most popular tales in African Oral Literature.

- **Definition:** A story featuring a protagonist (the Trickster) who uses cunning, intelligence, and deceit to outwit a physically stronger or more powerful opponent (the Dupe).
- **The Trickster Character:**
    - Usually a small, physically weak animal (e.g., Hare, Spider, Tortoise, Squirrel). ○ They represent the triumph of **brain over brawn** (intelligence over strength).
    - They are morally ambiguous—sometimes they are heroes, sometimes they are selfish and greedy.
- **The Dupe (The Victim):**
    - Usually a large, strong, but foolish animal (e.g., Elephant, Lion, Hyena). ○ They often possess a character flaw like greed, vanity, or arrogance, which the Trickster exploits.
- **Structure of a Trickster Tale:**

1. **Friendship/Alliance:** The Trickster and Dupe often start as friends or partners (e.g., farming together).
2. **The Contract/Agreement:** They agree on a rule (e.g., "We will not eat the food until harvest").
3. **The Violation:** The Trickster breaks the rule secretly.
4. **The Trick/Deception:** The Trickster sets up the Dupe to take the blame or suffer the consequences.
5. **The Escape:** The Trickster escapes punishment, leaving the Dupe suffering.

3. Functions of Trickster Narratives

- **Validation of Intelligence:** They teach that wisdom is superior to brute strength.
- **Social Satire:** They mock people in power who misuse their strength (represented by the Lion or Elephant).
- **Outlet for Suppression:** They allow the "weak" (common people/children) to psychologically triumph over the "strong" (rulers/adults).
- **Warning:** They warn against the flaws of the Dupe (don't be greedy, don't be gullible).

4. Performance Techniques in Narratives To analyze a narrative fully, you must discuss *how* it is told.

- **Verbal Cues (Voice):**
    - **Tonal Variation:** Changing the voice to sound like a lion (deep/rough) or a hare (high/squeaky).
    - **Tempo:** Speaking fast during a chase scene; speaking slowly during a sad moment.
    - **Volume:** Whispering for secrets; shouting for commands.
    - **Ideophones:** Using sound words to describe actions (e.g., *swish, thud, kacha, prrr*).
- **Non-Verbal Cues (Body):**
    - **Gestures:** Using hands to demonstrate size, height, or direction.
    - **Facial Expressions:** Frowning to show anger, smiling for joy, widening eyes for fear.

- **Body Movement:** Stamping feet, jumping, crouching, or walking among the audience.
- **Mimicry:** Imitating the walk or posture of the animals in the story.

Tip for Learners: When analyzing a written text of an oral story, look for words that indicate sound (ideophones) or repetition. These are clues that the story was meant to be performed.

ACTIVITY FOR SUB-STRAND 2.1 & 5.1

1. **Role Play:** Choose a well-known trickster story (e.g., The Hare and the Hyena).
2. **Perform:** One student narrates while others act out the parts of the animals.
3. **Critique:** The class should discuss: Did the narrator change their voice? Did they use gestures? How did the audience react?
4. **Analysis:** Identify the specific trick used. What was the flaw of the victim that made the trick work?

SUB-STRAND 3.1, 6.1, 7.2, & 8.1: ORAL POETRY (SONGS)

1. Classification of Oral Poetry Songs are classified based on **context** (when they are sung) and **function** (why they are sung).

- **Lullabies:** Sung to comfort babies.
- **Initiation Songs:** Sung during rites of passage (circumcision/transition to adulthood).
- **Work Songs:** Sung to accompany manual labor.
- **Dirges:** Sung during funerals.
- **Love Songs:** Express romantic feelings.
- **Panegyrics:** Praise songs for heroes or leaders.
- **Play Songs:** Sung by children during games.

2. Focus: Lullabies (Sub-strand 6.1)

- **Context:** Sung by a caregiver (mother, grandmother, older sibling, or nanny) to a baby.
- **Features:**
    - **Soft/Slow Rhythm:** To induce sleep and relaxation.
    - **Repetitive:** The sound patterns (rocking rhythm) are more important than the words.
    - **Simple Diction:** Uses simple words, nonsense words, or humming (*la la la*). ○ **Monologue:** It is a one-way communication; the baby listens but does not

reply. ○ **Themes:** Often contain promises (gifts for the baby) or mild threats ("If you don't sleep, the hyena will come").

- **Social Commentary:** Interestingly, caregivers often sing about their own frustrations (bad husbands, hard work) because the baby cannot understand the complaint.

- **Functions:**
  - Soothes the baby to sleep. ○ Quiets a crying child. ○ Allows the caregiver to express personal emotions.

3. Focus: Initiation Songs (Sub-strand 8.1)

- **Context:** Sung during the transition from childhood to adulthood (circumcision or traditional instruction periods).
- **Features:**
  - **Serious Tone:** These are not for fun; they are solemn and ritualistic.
  - **Didactic (Teaching):** The lyrics contain the laws, secrets, and history of the community.
  - **Encouragement/Mockery:** Some songs encourage the initiate to be brave; others mock cowardice to ensure they don't cry during the cut.
- **Functions:**
  - mark the transition from one stage of life to another. ○ Teach the responsibilities of adulthood.
  - Build a bond among the age-set (those initiated together). ○ Preserve the cultural secrets of the tribe.

4. Focus: Play Songs (Sub-strand 6.1)

- **Context:** Sung by children during leisure time.
- **Features:**
    - **Call and Response:** A leader sings a line, and the group responds. ○ **Fast Rhythm:** Matches the energy of the game.
    - **Kinetic:** Always accompanied by movement (dancing, clapping, jumping).
- **Functions:**
    - Teach counting or vocabulary.
    - Foster social cooperation and teamwork. ○ Physical exercise and enjoyment.

5. Analyzing Oral Poetry When given a song text to analyze, look for:

- **Repetition:** Are words or lines repeated? (Creates emphasis and rhythm).
- **Refrain/Chorus:** Is there a section repeated after every stanza? (Encourages audience participation).
- **Imagery:** Does the singer use similes or metaphors? (e.g., "He is a lion" for bravery).
- **Sound Patterns:**
    - **Alliteration:** Repetition of consonant sounds (e.g., "Sing a sad song"). ○ **Assonance:** Repetition of vowel sounds. ○ **Onomatopoeia:** Sound words.

Tip for Learners: If you are asked to describe the "mood" of a song, look at the words. A dirge will have a sad, somber mood. A wedding song will have a jubilant, celebratory mood. A work song will have a vigorous, energetic mood.

ACTIVITY FOR ORAL POETRY

1. **Collect:** Ask a parent or guardian to sing a traditional song to you (or use a song you know).
2. **Transcribe:** Write down the words in the local language and translate them into English.
3. **Classify:** Is it a lullaby? A work song? A wedding song?
4. **Performance:** In class, recite the English translation while trying to keep the original rhythm.

SUB-STRAND 4.1: SHORT FORMS (FIXED FORMS)

1. Proverbs

- **Definition:** A short, pithy saying that expresses a general truth or piece of wisdom.
- **Features:**
    - **Metaphorical:** It uses one thing to mean another (e.g., "A stitch in time saves nine" is about solving problems early, not sewing).
    - **Fixed:** The wording is rarely changed.
    - **Compact:** It packs a lot of meaning into a few words.
- **Functions:**
    - **Conflict Resolution:** Used to settle disputes without direct confrontation. ○ **Advising/Warning:** Giving advice in a polite way.
    - **Aesthetic:** "Proverbs are the palm oil with which words are eaten" (Chinua Achebe) – they make speech beautiful and sophisticated.

2. Riddles

- **Definition:** A word puzzle in which a question is asked (the challenge) and an answer is expected (the solution).
- **Structure:**
    1. **Challenge:** The challenger invites the audience (e.g., "Riddle riddle!").
    2. **Acceptance:** The audience accepts (e.g., "Riddle come!").
    3. **The Puzzle:** The challenger gives the descriptive statement (e.g., "I have a house with no door").
    4. **Guesses:** The audience tries to guess.
    5. **Prize (if necessary):** If they fail, they must "give" a prize (like a city or cattle) to get the answer.

6. **The Solution:** The answer is given (e.g., "An egg").

- **Functions:**
  - **Mental Training:** Teaches children to think logically and observe their environment.
  - **Entertainment:** A competitive game. ○ **Education:** Teaches the characteristics of objects and animals.

3. Tongue Twisters

- **Definition:** A sequence of words that is difficult to pronounce quickly and correctly.
- **Features:**
  - Uses **Alliteration** (repetition of initial sounds).
  - Meant to be spoken rapidly.
- **Functions:**
  - **Speech Therapy:** Trains children to pronounce words clearly and fluently. ○ **Entertainment:** It is funny when people make mistakes. ○ **Language Training:** Teaches the distinct sounds of a language.

4. Puns

- **Definition:** A play on words, often exploring the dual meaning of a word or words that sound similar.
- **Function:** Humor and linguistic cleverness.

ACTIVITY FOR SHORT FORMS

1. **Riddle Contest:** Divide the class into two teams. Conduct a riddling session. Keep score.

2. **Proverb Match:** Write a list of proverbs. Write a list of "situations" (e.g., a student who is lazy, a friend who is betraying you). Match the correct proverb to the situation.

SUB-STRAND 7.1: MODERN FORMS OF ORAL LITERATURE

1. The Evolution of Oral Literature Oral literature is not dead; it has evolved with technology and modern society. It has moved from the village fireside to the radio, television, and internet.

2. Types of Modern Oral Forms

- **Spoken Word Poetry:**
    - Performance-based poetry often focused on social justice, politics, or identity. ○ Performed at slams, theatres, or on YouTube. ○ Relies heavily on rhythm, wordplay, and voice modulation (just like traditional oral poetry).
- **FM Radio Narratives:**
    - Radio presenters telling stories or listeners calling in to share "confessions" or dilemmas.
    - This mimics the communal storytelling session, where the whole "nation" is the audience.
- **Stand-up Comedy:**
    - Comedians function like modern tricksters or traditional satirists.
    - They use humor to critique politicians, social norms, and human behavior.
- **Social Media Storytelling (TikTok/Instagram/YouTube):**
    - Short skits or storytelling videos.
    - Features: Visual effects, fast pace, viral trends (repetition/variation).
- **Music (Hip-hop/Rap/Genge):**
    - Rap is essentially oral poetry set to a beat.
    - It serves the same functions: protest, identity, storytelling, and boasting (panegyric).

3. Features Preserved in Modern Forms

- **Performance:** It still requires an artist and delivery.
- **Audience Interaction:** Instead of clapping, the audience "likes," "comments," or

"shares."

- **Orality:** It is primarily consumed through hearing/watching, not reading text.

Tip for Learners: When asked how oral literature is kept alive today, mention technology. Recording devices, radio, and the internet have become the new "memory" of the community.

ACTIVITY FOR MODERN FORMS

1. **Compare:** Listen to a traditional praise song and a modern hip-hop track. What similarities do you hear in the rhythm or the way the artist boasts about themselves?
2. **Create:** Write and perform a "Spoken Word" piece about a modern issue (e.g., Climate Change or Mental Health) using oral features like repetition and rhyme.

SUB-STRAND 9.1: ORAL LITERATURE FIELDWORK

1. Introduction to Fieldwork Since oral literature lives in the community, we cannot study it fully in a library. We must go to the "field" (the community) to collect it.

2. Stages of Fieldwork Fieldwork is a scientific process involving three main stages:

A. Preparation (Pre-Fieldwork) Before going out, you must plan.

- **Identify the Purpose:** What are you looking for? (e.g., "I want to collect proverbs about women").
- **Select the Area:** Where will you go?
- **Identify Informants:** Who will give you the information? (e.g., grandmothers, village elders, children).
- **Secure Permission:** Get official clearance from school and local authorities (Chief/Village Elder).
- **Prepare Equipment:** Get notebooks, pens, cameras, and voice recorders (phones).
- **Budgeting:** Plan for transport and lunch.

B. Data Collection (The Fieldwork) This is the actual gathering of material. You need methods:

- **Observation:** Watching a performance (e.g., a wedding song) and noting actions, costumes, and reactions.
- **Interview:** Asking the performer questions.
    - *Structured Interview:* Using a strict list of questions. ○ *Unstructured Interview:* A casual conversation.
- **Participation:** Joining in the dance or song to feel the rhythm and emotion (Participant Observation).
- **Recording:** Using audio or video to capture the exact words and sounds.
- **Note-taking:** Writing down non-verbal cues that audio recordings miss (e.g., "The singer cried at this point").

C. Post-Fieldwork (Processing) After returning, the work continues.

- **transcription:** Writing down the material exactly as it was recorded in the original language.
- **Translation:** Translating the material into English so others can understand.
    - *Word-for-word translation:* Keeps the exact structure (good for analysis).
    - *Free translation:* Focuses on meaning and flow (good for reading).
- **Analysis:** Classifying the work (genre), identifying features, and interpreting the message.
- **Dissemination:** Presenting the findings (report, essay, presentation).

3. Challenges in Fieldwork

- **Language Barrier:** If the student does not understand the local dialect.
- **Hostility:** Informants might be suspicious or refuse to share secrets.
- **Transport/Funds:** Lack of money to travel.
- **Equipment Failure:** Batteries dying or memory cards filling up.
- **Taboos:** Some stories cannot be told during the day; some songs cannot be sung by women, etc.

4. Ethical Considerations

- **Consent:** Always ask permission before recording someone.
- **Respect:** Respect the culture and traditions of the community. Do not laugh at their beliefs.
- **Credit:** Acknowledge the source of your information (name the storyteller).

- **Confidentiality:** If an informant asks to remain anonymous, respect that.

ACTIVITY FOR FIELDWORK

1. **Mini-Project:** Plan a fieldwork session within your school.
    - **Topic:** "School Legends" or "Nicknames of Teachers/Buildings." ○ **Informants:** Senior students or non-teaching staff. ○ **Method:** Interview them. ○ **Output:** Write a one-page report on a legend you discovered about your school.

SUMMARY OF KEY SKILLS FOR STRAND 1

By the end of this Strand, a Grade 10 learner should be able to:

- **Identify** the genre of any oral piece provided.
- **Describe** the performance features (voice, body, audience).
- **Explain** the social function of the piece (why was it performed?).
- **Classify** narratives (Trickster, Legend, Myth) and songs (Lullaby, Dirge, etc.).

- **Plan** a simple fieldwork activity involving preparation, collection, and analysis.

Final Exam Tip: In exams, you are often given a text (a story or song written down). Treat it as a script. When asked "How would you perform this line?", look at the punctuation and meaning. If it is a question, suggest "raising pitch." If it is a scary part, suggest "lowering voice" or "whispering." Always link your performance choice to the meaning of the text.

STRAND 2: POETRY

INTRODUCTION TO THESE NOTES

These notes cover the entire Poetry Strand as outlined in the Grade 10 curriculum. They are designed to move learners from the basic definition of poetry through to complex analysis of sound, structure, and style. The notes also include a practical guide on how to write poetry, emphasizing creativity and self-expression.

SUB-STRAND 1.2: INTRODUCTION TO POETRY

1. Understanding Poetry

- **Definition:** Poetry is a form of literature that uses aesthetic and rhythmic qualities of language to evoke meanings in addition to, or in place of, the prosaic ostensible meaning. It is language chosen and arranged to create a specific emotional response through meaning, sound, and rhythm.
- **The "Verse" Concept:** Unlike prose (novels/short stories) which is written in paragraphs, poetry is written in **verses** (lines) and **stanzas** (groups of lines).
- **Economy of Language:** Poetry often says "more with less." A single word in a poem can carry the weight of a whole sentence in a novel.
- **Sources of Poetry:**
    - **Written Sources:** Anthologies, textbooks, newspapers, magazines, and digital platforms.
    - **Oral Sources:** Songs, chants, oral narratives (which often contain poetic interludes), and spoken word performances.
    - **The Environment:** Nature itself is a source of poetry; poets observe the world (trees, rivers, cities) and translate those observations into verse.

2. Elements of a Poem (Focus on Kenyan Context) To analyze a poem, learners must understand its building blocks.

- **The Speaker (Persona):**
    - The "voice" talking in the poem.
    - **Tip:** Never assume the speaker is the poet. If a male poet writes a poem about a mother crying, the speaker is the "Mother," not the poet.
- **Subject Matter:**
    - What the poem is literally about (the topic). ○ Example: A poem describing a mango tree.
- **Theme:**
    - The underlying message or central idea. ○ Example: The mango tree represents resilience or providing shelter (The theme of Nature's Care).
- **Mood:**
    - The atmosphere or feeling the poem creates in the reader (e.g., sad, scary, peaceful, jubilant).
- **Tone:**

- The attitude of the speaker towards the subject (e.g., angry, sarcastic, loving, bitter).

- **Structure:**
  - How the poem is built (lines, stanzas, rhythm, rhyme).

ACTIVITY FOR SUB-STRAND 1.2

1. **Collection:** Visit the school library or use the internet to find one poem written by a Kenyan poet (e.g., Marjorie Oludhe Macgoye, Jared Angira, or a younger spoken word artist).
2. **Identification:** Read the poem aloud. Identify:
   - Who is speaking? o What is the mood? o Is it divided into stanzas?

STRAND 2.2: APPRECIATION OF POETRY (TYPES)

1. Classification by Structure and Form Poems are categorized based on how they are built.

SUB-

- **Free Verse:**
    - **Definition:** Poetry that does not follow a consistent rhyme scheme, rhythm, or meter.
    - **Features:** It sounds like natural speech. The poet decides where to break the line for emphasis, not to fit a beat.
    - **Why use it?** It offers total freedom to express complex ideas without being forced into a shape.
- **Blank Verse:**
    - **Definition:** Poetry written in regular meter (usually iambic pentameter—da-DUM da-DUM da-DUM da-DUM da-DUM) but **does not rhyme**.
    - **Usage:** often used in long narrative poems or dramas (like Shakespeare's plays) because it has a steady rhythm like a heartbeat but feels serious and grand.
- **The Sonnet:**
    - **Definition:** A poem of exactly **14 lines**. ○ **Structure:** It usually follows a strict rhyme scheme. ○ **Subject:** Traditionally used to express love or deep philosophical thoughts.
    - **The Volta:** A key feature of a sonnet is the "turn" or *volta*—a shift in thought or argument, usually happening near the end (around line 9 or the final couplet).
- **Narrative Poems:**
    - **Definition:** A poem that tells a story.

      Features: It has a plot, characters, setting, and conflict, just like a short story, but it is written in verse.

-
- **Examples:** Epics (long hero stories) or Ballads (songs that tell sad stories).

2. Performance of Poetry Poetry is meant to be heard.

- **Verbal Techniques:**
  - **Stress:** Emphasizing important words. ○ **Pause:** Stopping briefly (caesura) to let a meaning sink in.
  - **Intonation:** Rising pitch for questions, falling pitch for statements.
- **Non-Verbal Techniques:**
  - **Facial Expressions:** Showing the emotion of the speaker. ○ **Gestures:** Using hands to emphasize size or distance. ○ **Movement:** Moving across the stage to show a change in time or setting.

ACTIVITY FOR SUB-STRAND 2.2

1. **Comparison:** Find a Sonnet (14 lines) and a Free Verse poem. Place them side by side. How does the look on the page differ?
2. **Performance:** Choose a Narrative Poem. In groups, "act out" the story while one person recites it.

STRAND 3.2: THE WRITING PROCESS (CREATING

SUB-
POETRY)

1. The Myth of the "Genius" Learners often think poets just sit down and write a perfect poem instantly. This is false. Poetry writing is a **process** involving craft and revision.

2. The Steps of Writing a Poem

- **Step 1: Conception/Inspiration:**
    - Finding a trigger. This could be a memory, a news story, a beautiful sunset, or a strong emotion (anger/joy).
- **Step 2: Brainstorming:**
    - Listing ideas, images, and phrases related to the topic.
    - *Tip:* Don't worry about order yet. Just get the words out. If the topic is "Rain," list: wet, mud, life, roof, tapping sound, floods, tea.
- **Step 3: Determining Structure and Style:**
    - Decide: Will this be a rhyming poem? A free verse poem? ○ Decide the Tone: Will it be a funny poem or a serious one?
- **Step 4: Drafting:**
    - Write the first version. Arrange the brainstormed words into lines and stanzas.
- **Step 5: Incubation (Optional but recommended):**
    - Put the poem away for a few hours or days. Come back to it with fresh eyes.
- **Step 6: Revision and Editing:**
    - **The "Kill your darlings" phase:** Remove words that are unnecessary.

- Replace weak words (e.g., "The big dog") with strong imagery (e.g., "The towering hound").
- Check the rhythm. Read it aloud. Does it stumble?

- **Step 7: Titling:**
  - Choose a title that adds meaning, don't just label it. Instead of "The Cow," try "The Silent Grazer."
- **Step 8: Publishing/Sharing:**
  - Share with peers for feedback or post on a classroom board/portfolio.

3. Focus Topic: Environmental Conservation The curriculum suggests writing on **Climate Change/Environment**.

- *Idea:* Write from the perspective of a drying river. What does the river see? What does it feel?

ACTIVITY FOR SUB-STRAND 3.2

1. **Workshop:** "The Object Poem." Place an object (e.g., an old shoe) in the center of the class.
2. **Draft:** Everyone writes 5 lines about the object.
3. **Edit:** Swap papers with a neighbor. The neighbor must circle one word they think is weak and suggest a stronger one.

SUB-
STRAND 4.2 & 5.2: SOUND PATTERNS IN POETRY

1. The Music of Poetry Poetry is "musical speech." Sound patterns are devices used to create rhythm, mood, and memorability.

2. Sound Patterns Type A (Sub-strand 4.2)

- **Onomatopoeia:**
  - **Definition:** The use of English words that imitate the sound they describe. ○ **Examples:** *Bang, crash, hiss, buzz, murmur, whisper.*
  - **Function:** It brings the scene to life; the reader "hears" the action.
- **Ideophones:**
  - **Definition:** These are sound-symbolic words, often derived from African languages or local dialects, that depict sensory experiences (sound, movement, color, texture).
  - **Difference from Onomatopoeia:** Onomatopoeia are standard dictionary words. Ideophones are often dramatic creations or borrowings from local languages. ○ **Examples:** *Tu!* (silence/breaking), *Pata pata* (running feet), *Charrr* (tearing cloth).
  - **Function:** They add intense vividness and "local flavor" to the poem.
- **Rhyme:**
  - **Definition:** The repetition of identical sounds at the ends of lines. ○ **Rhyme Scheme:** The pattern of rhyme (e.g., AABB, ABAB). ○

- **Function:** It creates a predictable, pleasing rhythm and links ideas together.

3. Sound Patterns Type B (Sub-strand 5.2)

- **Alliteration:**
    - **Definition:** The repetition of **consonant sounds** at the **beginning** of words that are close together.
    - **Example:** "**S**ing a **s**ong of **s**ixpence." / "**D**ark **d**reary **d**ays." ○ **Function:** It creates rhythm and can influence mood (e.g., 'S' sounds can be soothing or sinister; 'B' and 'D' sounds are hard and forceful).
- **Assonance:**
    - **Definition:** The repetition of **vowel sounds** within words that are close together.
        - **Example:** "The r**ai**n in Sp**ai**n st**ay**s mainly on the pl**ai**n." (Repetition of the 'Ay' sound).
    - **Function:** It creates an internal echo and musical flow (euphony).
- **Consonance:**
    - **Definition:** The repetition of **consonant sounds** within or at the end of words (not necessarily at the start).
    - **Example:** "The lint was se**nt** with the te**nt**." / "Pi**tter** Pa**tter**." ○ **Function:** It adds texture to the sound of the poem.

ACTIVITY FOR SUB-STRAND 4.2 & 5.2

1. **Sound Hunt:** Take a poem provided by the teacher. Use three different colored highlighters.
    - Yellow: Alliteration. ○ Green: Assonance.

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- Blue: Rhyme.

2. **Creation:** Write a two-line couplet describing a thunderstorm using **onomatopoeia** (e.g., "Boom," "Crash") and **alliteration**.

STRAND 6.2: REPETITION, REFRAIN, AND CHORUS

1. Repetition

- **Definition:** Using the same word, phrase, or line more than once.
- **Functions:**
    - **Emphasis:** It tells the reader "This is important." ○ **Rhythm:** It creates a beat. ○ **Unity:** It ties the different parts of the poem together.

2. The Refrain

- **Definition:** A specific line or phrase that is repeated at regular intervals, usually at the end of a stanza.
- **Example:** In a poem about war, the line "And the guns kept firing" might appear at the end of every verse.
- **Function:** It haunts the reader. It serves as a constant reminder of the central theme.

3. The Chorus

- **Definition:** A group of lines (a whole stanza) repeated in a song or poem.
- **Origin:** Borrowed from oral performance and music.
- **Function:** It allows for audience participation (everyone joins in the chorus) and reinforces the main message.

ACTIVITY FOR SUB-STRAND 6.2

1. **Choral Verse:** Divide the class into groups. Choose a poem with a refrain.

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- Group A reads Stanza 1.
- Whole Class reads the Refrain together.
- Group B reads Stanza 2.
- Whole Class reads the Refrain together.

2. **Discussion:** How did saying the refrain *together* change the feeling of the poem?

STRAND 7.2 & 9.2: SUBJECT MATTER AND THEMES

(KENYAN CONTEXT)

1. Subject Matter vs. Theme Learners often confuse these two.

- **Subject Matter:** The surface-level topic. (e.g., "A poem about a man cutting down a Mugumo tree.")
- **Theme:** The deeper message. (e.g., "The conflict between tradition and modernity" or "Environmental destruction.")

2. Themes in Poems from Kenya Kenyan poetry often explores specific shared experiences.

- **Environmental Conservation:** Poems discussing the loss of forests, the pollution of Nairobi rivers, or the beauty of the Savannah.
    - *Significance:* These poems urge us to protect our heritage and survival.
- **Cultural Identity:** Poems about village life vs. city life, preserving local languages, or respecting elders.
- **Poverty and Inequality:** Poems highlighting the gap between the rich (in leafy suburbs) and the poor (in informal settlements).
- **Love and Relations:** Not just romantic love, but love for the land (patriotism) and love for family.
- **Mental Health:** (A growing theme) Poems expressing anxiety, depression, or the struggle for self-acceptance.

3. Analysis of Subject Matter When analyzing a Kenyan poem:

- Identify the **Setting**: Is it rural (shamba) or urban (matatu stage)?

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- Identify the **Characters**: Who are the people mentioned?
- Identify the **Action**: What is happening?

ACTIVITY FOR SUB-STRAND 7.2 & 9.2

1. **Theme Collage:** Select a theme (e.g., "City Life in Kenya").
2. **Create:** Cut out pictures from magazines or draw images that represent this theme. Write a short poem to accompany the collage.
3. **Debate:** "Does poetry have the power to change society?" Discuss how a poem about the environment might change how a student treats litter.

STRAND 8.2: LANGUAGE AND STYLE (IMAGERY)

1. Imagery

- **Definition:** Language that appeals to the five senses (sight, sound, taste, touch, smell). It creates a "picture" in the reader's mind.
- **Function:** It makes the poem vivid and real. Instead of saying "It was hot," imagery says "The sun scorched the dry earth like a furnace."

2. Simile

- **Definition:** A direct comparison between two unlike things using the words **"like"** or **"as."**
- **Examples:**
    - "He is **as** strong **as** a buffalo." ○ "Her voice sounded **like** a cracking whip."
- **Tip:** The comparison must be between two *different* things (comparing a man to a buffalo is a simile; comparing a man to another man is just a description).

3. Metaphor

- **Definition:** An indirect comparison where one thing is said to **be** another (without using "like" or "as").
- **Examples:**

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- "He **is** a lion in battle." (Meaning: He is brave).
- "The classroom was a zoo." (Meaning: It was noisy and chaotic).

- **The Extended Metaphor:** When a metaphor continues throughout the whole poem. For example, a poem that describes life entirely as a "journey" (roads, hills, valleys, stops) without mentioning the word "life."

4. Importance of Imagery

- It engages the reader's imagination.
- It simplifies complex ideas (comparing "love" to a "rose" helps us understand love has beauty but also thorns).

ACTIVITY FOR SUB-STRAND 8.2

1. **The Transformation:** Write a list of 5 boring sentences (e.g., "The tea was hot.").
2. **Rewrite:** Change each sentence into a Simile or Metaphor (e.g., "The tea was liquid fire in my throat.").
3. **Guessing Game:** One student says a metaphor (e.g., "My brother is a giraffe"). The class must guess the meaning (e.g., "He is tall").

SUMMARY OF KEY SKILLS FOR STRAND 2

By the end of this Strand, a Grade 10 learner should be able to:

- **Differentiate** between a poem and a short story.
- **Analyze** the sound patterns (alliteration, rhyme, etc.) and explain *why* the poet used them.
- **Identify** the specific type of poem (Sonnet, Free Verse).
- **Write** their own poem following a structured process (brainstorming to editing).
- **Discuss** themes relevant to Kenya (environment, culture) found in poetry.
- **Perform** a poem using appropriate verbal and non-verbal cues.

Examination Tip: In an exam, if you are asked to "Describe the rhythm of the poem," look for rhyme and line length. If the lines are short and rhyme, the rhythm is likely "fast and regular." If the lines are long and free verse, the rhythm is "slow and conversational." Always give evidence from the text.

STRAND 3: FICTION AND NON-FICTION

INTRODUCTION TO THESE NOTES

This strand is the heaviest in the curriculum (suggested 105 lessons). It covers the major forms of written literature. Since the specific books (setbooks) vary from school to school, these notes focus on the **skills of analysis**. Think of this as a "User Manual" for reading. Whether you are reading a novel about Kenyan history or a play about family conflict, the tools below remain the same.

SUB-STRAND 1.3: INTRODUCTION TO PROSE FICTION

1. Defining Prose Fiction

- **Prose:** This refers to ordinary language. It is written in sentences and paragraphs, unlike poetry which is written in verses and stanzas. It mimics the natural flow of speech.
- **Fiction:** This implies that the work is a product of the imagination. While it may be inspired by true events, the characters and specific dialogues are created by the author.
- **Prose Fiction:** Therefore, these are imaginary stories written in ordinary language.

2. The Three Main Forms of Prose Fiction To analyze fiction, you must first identify the "container" or form.

- **The Novel:** A long narrative (usually over 40,000 words). It has a complex plot, many characters, multiple settings, and explores themes in great depth. It requires sustained attention to read.
- **The Novella:** Shorter than a novel but longer than a short story. It usually focuses on one major conflict or character but has more room for development than a short story.
- **The Short Story:** A brief narrative that can usually be read in one sitting. It focuses on a single incident, a limited number of characters, and evokes a single powerful effect or mood.

3. The Relationship Between Fiction and History The curriculum specifically asks learners to examine elements of **history** in prose fiction.

- **Historical Context:** No book is written in a vacuum. A novel written in Kenya in the 1960s will reflect the struggle for Independence (Mau Mau). A novel written in 2024 might reflect the digital age.
- **Verisimilitude:** This is a literary term meaning "the appearance of being true." Even though a novel is made up, it must *feel* real. Authors use historical facts (dates, real locations like Nairobi or Mombasa, real events) to ground their imaginary story in reality.
- **Fiction as History:** Sometimes, fiction tells the "emotional history" of a people better than a history textbook. A textbook gives facts; a novel gives feelings.

Tip for Learners: When reading a novel, always check the **Year of Publication** and the **Setting Time**. Ask yourself: "What was happening in Kenya (or the world) during this time?" This is the key to understanding the author's motivation.

ACTIVITY FOR SUB-STRAND 1.3

- **Historical Detective:** Pick a novel you are reading. Find three "facts" in it (e.g., a mention of a specific President, a type of technology like a rotary phone, or a historical event). Research these three facts. How accurately did the author portray them?

SUB-STRAND 2.3, 3.3, & 7.3: THE NOVEL AND SHORT STORY (ELEMENTS OF ANALYSIS)

To "critically analyze" a text, you must break it down into its components.

1. Plot Structure (The Skeleton) The plot is the sequence of events. It is the "what happens." However, for Grade 10 analysis, you must understand *how* it is arranged.

- **Exposition:** The beginning. It introduces the characters, the setting, and the status quo (normal life).
- **Inciting Incident:** The event that disrupts normal life and starts the story (e.g., a stranger arrives, a crime is committed).
- **Rising Action:** The series of complications. The protagonist tries to solve the problem but faces obstacles. Tension builds.
- **Climax:** The turning point. The moment of highest tension where the protagonist faces the main conflict. The outcome is decided here.
- **Falling Action:** The aftermath of the climax. Loose ends start to be tied up.
- **Resolution (Dénouement):** The end. A new "normal" is established.

2. Character and Characterization (The Soul)

- **Character:** The person (or animal) in the story.
- **Characterization:** The *method* the author uses to reveal the character's personality.
    - **Direct Characterization:** The author tells you plainly (e.g., "Okello was a greedy man").

- **Indirect Characterization:** The author *shows* you. You must infer the personality through:
  - **S**peech (What do they say? How do they speak?)
  - **T**houghts (What are they thinking secretly?)
  - **E**ffect on others (Do people fear them or love them?)
  - **A**ctions (What do they do?)
  - **L**ooks (How do they dress or appear?)

- **Types of Characters:**
  - **Protagonist:** The main character (the hero/heroine, though not always "good").
  - **Antagonist:** The force opposing the main character (the villain, or society, or nature).
  - **Dynamic Character:** A character who changes or grows by the end of the story.
  - **Static Character:** A character who stays the same throughout.
  - **Round Character:** Complex, realistic, has both good and bad traits.
  - **Flat Character:** One-dimensional, represents a single idea (e.g., "The wicked stepmother").

3. Setting (The World) Setting is more than just "where." It includes:

- **Physical Setting:** Geography, weather, buildings (e.g., A dusty village in Turkana vs. a skyscraper in Nairobi).
- **Temporal Setting:** Time of day, year, or historical era.
- **Social Setting:** The cultural norms, beliefs, and political atmosphere.

- *Example:* A story set in a school has a "social setting" of rules, hierarchy, and peer pressure.

4. Themes (The Message)

- **Subject Matter vs. Theme:**
  - Subject Matter is the topic (e.g., "A story about two brothers fighting"). ○ Theme is the opinion or message about that topic (e.g., "Betrayal destroys family bonds").
- **Universal Themes:** These are ideas that apply to all humans, regardless of culture (e.g., Love, Death, Coming of Age, Corruption, Power).

5. Language and Style (The Paint) This is often the hardest part for learners. It asks: *How* did the author write this?

- **Diction:** The choice of words. Are they simple, complex, slang (Sheng), or poetic?
- **Syntax:** The sentence structure. Long, flowing sentences (calm) vs. short, choppy sentences (tense/action).
- **Narrative Voice (Point of View):**
  - **First Person ("I"):** Intimate, subjective, limited to one person's view. ○ **Third Person Limited ("He/She"):** Follows one character but uses "he/she." ○ **Third Person Omniscient:** The "All-knowing" narrator who can see into everyone's heads.

- **Symbolism:** Using an object to represent an idea (e.g., a dying tree representing a dying culture).

Exam Tip: When discussing style, never just say "The author uses style." Be specific. Say, "The author uses *vivid imagery* to describe the setting," or "The author uses *local dialect* to make the dialogue authentic."

ACTIVITY FOR SUB-STRAND 2.3/3.3

- **Character Profile:** Create a "Facebook Profile" or "Bio" for the main character in your novel. List their Likes (Values), Dislikes (Fears), Friends (Allies), and Status Updates (Key plot points).

SUB-STRAND 5.3 & 8.3: THE PLAY (DRAMA)

1. Distinguishing Fiction from Drama A novel is meant to be *read* in private; a play is meant to be *watched* in public. This changes how we analyze it.

2. Elements of a Play Script

- **Dialogue:** This is the main engine of a play. In a novel, the narrator tells you what happens. In a play, the characters tell you through talking.
- **Stage Directions:** These are the instructions usually written in italics or brackets (e.g., *[He exits angrily]*, *[The lights dim]*). They tell the actors what to do and describe the setting.
- **Acts and Scenes:**
    - **Act:** A major division of the play (like a Part in a book). ○ **Scene:** A smaller division where the setting usually stays the same.

3. Dramatic Techniques (Style in Drama) When analyzing a play, look for these specific devices:

- **Soliloquy:** A character speaks their private thoughts aloud while alone on stage. This is the only way the audience knows what they are thinking.
- **Monologue:** A long speech given by one character to other characters on stage.
- **Aside:** A brief comment made by a character to the audience, which the other characters on stage "cannot hear."

- **Dramatic Irony:** When the audience knows something that the characters do not. (e.g., We know the killer is hiding behind the door, but the hero does not. This creates suspense).
- **Flashback:** Enacting a scene from the past to explain the present.

4. Performance Techniques (Sub-strand 8.3) The curriculum asks you to analyze "Performance." If you are reading the book in class, you must *imagine* the performance.

- **Blocking:** Where do the actors stand? If a character stands on a chair, it shows power. If they kneel, it shows submission.
- **Costume and Props:** What are they wearing? A torn shirt might symbolize poverty. A crown symbolizes authority.
- **Lighting:** Red light might suggest danger or anger. Blue light might suggest night or sadness.
- **Sound Effects:** Thunder, birds singing, or ominous music.

ACTIVITY FOR SUB-STRAND 8.3

- **The Director's Chair:** Choose one page from the play you are studying. Draw a sketch of the stage. Label where the characters are standing. Write notes on what lighting you would use and what costumes they should wear. Explain *why* (e.g., "I want the King to wear black to show he is evil").

SUB-STRAND 1.3.2 - 9.3.2: NON-FICTION PROSE

Non-fiction is literature based on fact. However, "literary non-fiction" uses the tools of fiction (plot, imagery) to tell true stories. The curriculum covers four specific types:

A. The Personal Journal (Sub-strand 2.3.2)

- **Definition:** A daily record of personal events, thoughts, and feelings.
- **Structure:**
    - **Chronological:** Written by date (e.g., "12th October 2025").
    - **Fragmented:** It may not have a continuous plot; it jumps from day to day.
- **Content:**
    - Highly personal and private. ○ Focuses on immediate reactions to events.
    - Often explores the writer's inner emotions (confession).
- **Language/Style:**
    - **First Person:** Always "I." ○ **Informal/Colloquial:** Since it is written for oneself, the grammar may be relaxed. ○ **Subjective:** It gives only one side of the story.

B. Autobiography (Sub-strand 3.3.2 & 5.3.2)

- **Definition:** An account of a person's life written by that person. (Auto = Self, Bio = Life, Graphy = Writing).

- **Structure:** Usually chronological, starting from birth/childhood and moving to the present.
- **Purpose:**
    - To document a legacy. ○ To explain one's actions or public life.
    - To inspire others through overcoming struggle.
- **Key Element - The "Double Voice":** In an autobiography, there are two "I"s.

    1. The **Narrating "I"**: The older person writing the book now (wise, reflective).
    2. The **Experiencing "I"**: The younger version of themselves in the story (innocent, making mistakes).

- **Comparison:**
    - *Biography:* Someone else writing about your life. ○ *Autobiography:* You writing about your life.

C. The Memoir (Sub-strand 6.3.2 & 7.3.2)

- **Definition:** A collection of memories that focuses on a specific *theme* or *period* of the author's life, rather than the whole life.
- **Difference from Autobiography:**
    - *Autobiography:* "My Life from Birth to Today." (Focus is on the timeline).

- *Memoir:* "My Years as a Teacher" or "My Struggle with Illness." (Focus is on a specific experience or theme).

- **Style:** Memoirs often feel more like novels. They focus heavily on recreating scenes, dialogue, and atmosphere (sensory details).

D. Literary Journalism (Sub-strand 9.3.2)

- **Definition:** This is also known as "Narrative Journalism" or "Creative Non-fiction." It is a form of writing where a journalist reports on a true event (news) but uses the techniques of fiction (characterization, scene-setting, interior monologue) to tell the story.
- **Features:**
  - **Truth:** The facts must be accurate (names, dates, events).
  - **Immersion:** The writer often immerses themselves in the story, spending months with the subjects.
  - **Voice:** Unlike standard news reports which are objective and cold, literary journalism has a strong voice and point of view.
- **Example:** Instead of a news report saying "A fire burned the market yesterday," a literary journalist would write: "The smell of burnt plastic hung heavy in the dawn air as Mama Njeri sifted through the ashes of her stall."

GENERAL TIPS FOR ANALYZING FICTION AND NONFICTION

1. The "P.E.E." Method for Writing Notes When you are making your own notes or answering exam questions, use this structure:

- **P - Point:** State your idea. (e.g., "The main character is courageous.")
- **E - Evidence:** Give an example from the text. (e.g., "This is seen when she faces the lion alone.")
- **E - Explanation:** Explain why this matters. (e.g., "This shows that she is willing to risk her life for her village.")

2. Analyzing Titles Never ignore the title of the book or story.

- **Literal Meaning:** What does it actually say? (e.g., "The River Between" - a physical river).
- **Metaphorical Meaning:** What does it symbolize? (e.g., "The River Between" - the division between two communities or religions).

3. Cultural Relevance (Kenyan Context) The curriculum emphasizes "values for lifelong learning" and "Kenyan culture." When reading, always ask:

- What African/Kenyan tradition is being shown?
- Is this tradition being praised or criticized?
- What moral lesson does the author want the Kenyan youth to learn?

4. Critical Thinking Questions To get top marks, ask "Why?" and "So What?"

- *Don't just say:* "The setting is a forest."
- *Do say:* "The setting is a forest *because* the author wants to isolate the characters from civilization to test their survival instincts."

COMPREHENSIVE CHECKLIST FOR LITERARY ANALYSIS

Use this checklist whenever you finish reading a text in Strand 3. **A.**

For Novels and Short Stories:

- [ ] **Plot:** Can I draw the timeline of events? Where is the Climax?
- [ ] **Setting:** Where and When? How does the weather/location affect the mood?
- [ ] **Characters:** Who changes? Who stays the same? What are their flaws?
- [ ] **Theme:** What is the "Big Idea"? (Not just the topic).
- [ ] **Conflict:** Is it Man vs. Man? Man vs. Nature? Man vs. Self?
- [ ] **Style:** Is the language simple or hard? Is there a lot of imagery? **B. For Plays:**

- [ ] **Conflict:** What is the main argument or struggle driving the dialogue?
- [ ] **Stagecraft:** If I were directing this, what would the set look like?
- [ ] **Dramatic Irony:** What do I know that the characters don't?
- [ ] **Themes:** What social issue is the playwright highlighting? **C. For Non-**

Fiction (Autobiographies/Memoirs/Journals):

- [ ] **Tone:** Is the author angry, nostalgic (missing the past), apologetic, or proud?
- [ ] **Purpose:** Why did they write this? To teach? To confess? To preserve history?
- [ ] **Truth:** Is the narrator reliable? Or are they trying to make themselves look

better than they are?

ACTIVITY FOR GENERAL REVIEW

- **Genre Swap:** Take a simple nursery rhyme or story (like "Humpty Dumpty").
  - Rewrite it as a **Play Script** (with dialogue and stage directions).
  - Rewrite it as a **Personal Journal entry** (from Humpty's point of view before he fell).
  - Rewrite it as a **News Report** (Literary Journalism style: "Tragedy at the King's Wall").
  - *This helps you understand how Form changes the Story.*